



Project Format: Webinar/community event (i.e., two-month intensive program for English language learning and developing engaged citizens).

Project Title: English Language Learning for Systems Navigation and Civic Engagement

Introduction:

Start by providing a brief introduction to the project, highlighting its purpose, significance, and objectives. Clearly state the overall goal you aim to achieve through the project.

Our project is an extension of our existing Community E-Learning Initiative, which provides free English language learning instruction and academic support to newcomer parents and students in the Greater Toronto Area (GTA), primarily in the neighbourhoods of St. James Town and Regent Park. Our two-month intensive program, titled “English Language Learning for Systems Navigation and Civic Engagement”, will focus on assisting our existing program participants, who are primarily refugees from various areas of the Middle East and East Africa, and who have reported that they face difficulties with navigating their local school systems due to language barriers and lack of knowledge. Thus, the dual objectives of our two-month program are to equip newcomer parents with English language skills which can be used practically to advocate for themselves and their children within local education systems, and to equip parents with civic knowledge, which can be used to improve their local education systems. Thus, in addition to covering the fundamentals of the English language, our program’s curriculum will also mobilise knowledge around the following topics: 1) Types of school systems in Ontario; 2) Navigating different academic and applied learning streams for students; 3) Engaging your local school trustee; 4) Understanding the local civil service, and the role which municipal, provincial and federal governments have in your child’s access to education. We hope that our two-month intensive program, which would be administered as an extension of our E-Learning Initiative, not only improves the English language skills of newcomer parents, but also to provide them with civic engagement tools to help them improve education systems in their own communities.

Project Goals:

Our project goals are to:

- 1) Recruit approximately 20-30 newcomer parents to participate in a 4-8 week intensive English language learning program;
- 2) Mobilise civic knowledge around local school systems in Ontario, such as information about the Board of Trustees, Ontario's Education Ministry, and the provincial government's role in providing education to its citizens, in a way which is accessible to newcomer parents (i.e., translating information into Arabic, Somali and Amharic);
- 3) Prepare two hours of instruction a week, online and/or in-person, for participating parents, which feature guest speakers from the Ontario education community;
- 4) Design four practical assignments, which allow parents to develop civic engagement tools, which are co-designed between our volunteer team and local members of the Ontario education community (i.e., teachers, education assistants);
- 5) Facilitate program participants' attendance at the instructional/lecture sessions, as well as their completion of practical assignments; 6) Facilitate program participants' completion of a final project, which demonstrates their knowledge in a creative way.

Methods and Strategies:

The methods and strategies we will utilise to achieve our project goals are:

- 1) Recruitment of newcomer parents via word-of-mouth interviewing (i.e., phone calls), email campaigns to existing E-Learning Program participants, social media campaigns (i.e., Instagram) and flyering at local community hubs (i.e., Centre for Community Development and Learning in Regent Park);
- 2) Designing original promotional materials (i.e., flyers and social media graphics), which will be translated into Arabic, Somali and Amharic;
- 3) Hiring qualified community volunteers and guest speakers to provide instruction during our 4-8 week program, specifically, individuals who can speak to the following topics: 1) Types of schools in Ontario (i.e., elementary, middle and high school); 2) Types of academic streams for students, and educational programs (i.e., applied versus academic streams, education plans for children with learning disabilities, French immersion, the Catholic school board, etc.); 3) How to engage your local school trustee, and understanding the local civil service (i.e., how trustees are elected, how you can participate in elections, etc.), and how the municipal, provincial and federal governments are involved in you/your child's access to education/existing educational services;
- 4) Hosting in-person instructional sessions (i.e., seminars), as well as live-streaming them on Zoom (i.e., webinars), for two hours a week, for 4-8 weeks;
- 5) Designing four practical assignments for program participants to complete, which focus on mobilising civic knowledge as it concerns local education systems.

Activities and Tasks:

Our project will consist of the following activities and tasks, in chronological order:

- 1) **Promotional Activities:** Promotional activities will include printing and distributing flyers, designing online graphics, and completing phone calls;
- 2) **Hiring Guest Speakers:** Hiring guest speakers will be conducted via email and phone call, as well as social media;
- 3) **Hiring Volunteers:** Hiring volunteers will be conducted via surveying our existing volunteer base, as well as recruiting new volunteers via email and social media (i.e., Instagram, Facebook);
- 4) **Researching Civic Knowledge for Curriculum Design:** Research civic knowledge for our program's curriculum will be done via vetting resources submitted by our guest speakers, as well as conducting independent research with existing SWO volunteers using online databases and news articles;
- 5) **Creating a Workbook for Program Participants:** Completed civic knowledge and education equity research will be compiled into a workbook for participating members of the program;
- 6) **Locating a Suitable Venue:** We will locate a suitable venue to host the in-person learning sessions, a venue which will be located in either St. Jame's Town or Regent Park;
- 7) **Registering Participants and Distributing Workbooks:** Participants will be registered as program members, and workbooks will be delivered to them in-person prior to the workshop commencing;
- 8) **Administering Webinars/Seminars:** Webinars and seminars will be administered online and in-person, as well as recorded and distributed to program participants;
- 9) **Evaluating Practical Assignments:** Practical assignments completed by program participants will be sent to the SWO email and evaluated by our volunteers and guest speakers, collaboratively and iteratively.

A detailed syllabus of our 4-8 week program is provided below:

- A. English Language Learning (1-2 weeks)
 - a. Reading Comprehension
 - i. Lessons
 - ii. Practical 1 (Example: Reading a government website about OSAP and understanding which loans are available for you and your child)
 - b. Writing
 - i. Lessons
 - ii. Practical 2 (Example: Writing a letter to your school principal about improving infrastructure at school)
 - c. Speaking
 - i. Lessons

- ii. Practical 3 (Example: Advocating for your child: a practice conversation with your child's teacher)
- B. About Toronto's Social Services (Focus: Education Systems) (1-2 weeks)
 - a. Guest Speakers (Past volunteer speakers will be contacted first)
 - b. Topics:
 - i. Ontario's elementary, middle school and high school systems.
 - ii. The different types of educational plans available to students, especially students with learning disabilities.
 - iii. Types of streaming (i.e., academic versus applied).
 - iv. The policing system in schools and the Student Resource Officer program in schools.
 - v. The benefits of a Catholic private school or French immersion school.
- C. About Civic Engagement (1-2 weeks)
 - a. Guest Speakers
 - b. Topics:
 - i. Who to turn to if you have ideas for improving your child's school (i.e., what are parent's associations, teachers, principals)
 - ii. Who your local school trustee is, and how to become more involved in local politics.
 - iii. The role of the provincial education minister and the provincial government's role in the education system.
 - iv. The federal government's role in the education system.
 - v. How to petition your local Member of Parliament, or City Councillor, for change.
- D. Final Project: Creative Focus (1 week)
 - a. Parents can decide from a number of final projects.
 - i. Designing a Children's Book
 - ii. Writing a Formal Report
 - iii. Giving an Oral Presentation

Implementation Plan:

Present a clear and logical plan for implementing your project. Outline the steps you will take from start to finish, including any milestones or checkpoints along the way. Identify potential risks or challenges and propose contingency plans to mitigate them.

The main objective of this project is to create an intensive two-month intensive English language learning program, which focuses on developing English language skills amongst newcomer parents, as well as equipping them with the English language skills specifically needed to understand, navigate and engage with local education systems.

The following steps will be taken to achieve the objective of the program:

1. Sending emails to recruit potential internal volunteers at SWO who would be interested in supporting the development of the program. Once recruited, roles will be

delegated such as Project Managers, Event Coordination Team, Communications Team, Curriculum Design Team and Human Resources Team.

2. Once volunteers are recruited, and roles are assigned, tasks are to be delegated to each team. This includes the following:
 - a. Identifying and recruiting experienced guest speakers (to speak on navigating the education system) → Responsibility: Human Resources Team
 - b. Identifying, recruiting, and interviewing ESL educators who are interested in facilitating the program → Responsibility: Human Resources Team
 - c. Identify and hire a graphic designer with the purpose of creating promotional material for the program → Responsibility: Human Resources Team
 - d. Research and identify suitable venues for English language learning program to take place → Responsibility: Events Coordination Team
 - i. Once a suitable venue is found, payment is negotiated with vendor, and start and end date, and start time and end time of program is decided → Responsibility: Project Managers
 - e. The hired English language teacher and Curriculum Design team are to collaborate in creating comprehensive learning content, lessons, worksheets and collaborative activities that are in-line with the proposed syllabus and secondary objectives of the project: 1) Types of schools in Ontario (i.e., elementary, middle and high school); 2) Types of academic streams for students, and educational programs (i.e., applied versus academic streams, education plans for children with learning disabilities, French immersion, the Catholic school board, etc.); 3) How to engage your local school trustee, and understanding the local civil service (i.e., how trustees are elected, how you can participate in elections, etc.), and how the municipal, provincial and federal governments are involved in you/your child's access to education/existing educational services.
 - i. Once complete, the English Language teacher is to communicate with the Project Managers and Events Coordination Team to discuss materials needed to ensure the functioning of the program. This may include stationary products, and printed learning materials.
 - f. The hired guest speakers are to work with the Events Coordination team to discuss possible presentation topics during the program.
 - g. Once decided on possible topics for presentation, the guest speakers will work with the Events Coordination team and Communications Team to finalize slideshows and scripts.
 - h. In the midst of finalizing program activities and presentation topics from both ESL educators and guest speakers, the hired graphic designer and Communications Team are to create promotional content such as digital and printable brochures, flyers, and social media posts with the intention of promoting the program. A Google Form will be created by the Communications Team for participants to register for the program noting any accessibility and special accommodations requested from participants.

- i. Project Managers are to finalize a comprehensive event agenda that include what is to be taught each day, and the materials needed to ensure its success. This agenda is to be approved by all teams and hired members.
- j. With all event logistics finalized, venue purchased, and materials created, promotion of the program can begin. Flyers will be printed by Project Managers, and all teams are tasked to distribute the printed material at community centres.
- k. Once participants are recruited, the program is ready to kick off on the decided start date. The first day of the program will include an introductory session for participants, with discussion of individual and group goals for the program. Throughout each group meeting, the proposed syllabus and event logistics created will be implemented and come into fruition.
 - i. All members organizing the event (paid and volunteer) are to come before each group meeting to set up any activities that are to be completed by program participants. A run down of the agenda of the day will be printed and agreed upon by all members before participants arrive.

*Please note that all action items of the implementation plan will be overseen, with final decisions approved by project managers before being promoted, and implemented.

Key Milestones/Checkpoints include the recruitment of internal volunteers from SWO who are passionate and dedicated to supporting the development planning and implementation of the program. Other milestones include the hiring of graphic designers, who will be supporting the development of professionally made promotional material to support the recruitment of program participants. Further, the hiring of passionate, certified ESL educators to support the development of specific resources, lessons, and resources to our program participants. The major milestone would be the creation of comprehensive learning materials and list of resources for program participants.

Resource Allocation:

Resource	Budget	Notes
Hires: Guest speakers, Hired Instructors, Translators, Graphic Designers	\$3,605	Estimated 120 labour hours paid for \$30/hour = \$3,605 Volunteers prioritized, and all wages and other expenses to be negotiated.
Flyers/Brochure Printing	\$20	100 flyers/brochures * \$0.20 Proxy: https://www.staples.com/services/printing/copies-documents-printing/simple-prints/

Program Materials: Stationary	\$200 - 300	Low: 20 participants * \$10 bundle High: 30 participants * \$10 bundle
Program Materials: Printed Workbooks	\$120-180	Low: 20 participants * 30 pages *\$0.20 High: 30 participants * 30 pages *\$0.20 Proxy: https://www.staples.com/services/printing/copies-documents-printing/professional-print
Rental of Program Venue	\$215 - \$415	Low: \$25*2 hours*4 weeks+\$15 booking fee High: \$25*2 hours*8 weeks+\$15 booking fee Proxy: https://www.peerspace.com/ca/pages/listings/645bde697f79e6000e0bdeb2?sort_order=22 The workshop may be held remotely/hybrid in the case if limited funding is available. A venue located closer to the families will be chosen to increase accessibility if possible.
Contingency	\$500	
TOTAL	\$4,660 - \$5,000	

Monitoring and Evaluation:

Monitoring safety of participants to ensure the support of the: Starts With One operates with a zero tolerance for harassment. Should there be a complaint regarding a program participant, Project Managers are to address the complaint as soon as possible by supporting the person harmed, and speaking with the accused. Depending on the severity of the claim, it may result in the accused leaving the program altogether.

Evaluation: A survey will be created and distributed towards the end of the program to include quantitative and qualitative data such as: scaling questions and open ended questions in measuring the effectiveness of the program. Participants are to speak of their experience of the program truthfully, and feedback given from the survey will be used for future initiatives. The survey will also serve as a way to analyze if the program meets its overall objectives as stated in earlier sections. The data will also be used for future impact reports and strategic plans to analyze if the program met the overall vision and mission of Starts With One.

Some other performance indicators we will use to monitor and evaluate our project consist of the following:

- Customer (i.e., Participant) Complaints: Ensuring that there are a low number of complaints from participants.
- Customer (i.e., Participant) Retention Rate: Ensuring that registered participants remain in the program from start to finish.
- Positive Customer (i.e., Participant) Reviews: Ensuring that registered participants provide positive reviews of the program.
- Operating Margins: Ensuring that we adhere to our proposed budget.
- Labor Utilisation: Ensuring that we maximise the number of volunteers utilised, as opposed to paid guest speakers or instructors.
- Employee (i.e., Volunteer, Hired Instructor) Turnover Rate: Ensuring that volunteers and hired guest speakers complete their assigned objectives.
- Employee (i.e., Volunteer, Hired Instructor) Absence Rate: Ensuring that volunteers and hired instructors are present for their volunteer or paid commitments.
- Processes and Procedures Developed: Ensuring that our program curriculum is well-developed and the webinar and seminar are executed as according to our implementation plan.

Project Timeline:

Present a detailed timeline that illustrates the start and end dates of each activity or milestone. This timeline will help visualise the project's progress and ensure that activities are completed within the designated timeframes. **REMEMBER DEADLINE TO SUBMIT YOUR FINAL PROJECT IS ON NOVEMBER.**

September - November 15, 2023	E-learning Tutoring Lessons and Community Event Ideation E-learning tutoring lessons, including ESL, will be provided to students throughout the project. In this phase, the project managers and executive teams will conduct needs assessments to determine gaps in our community's civic engagement and how this can be addressed.
November 16 - December 20, 2023	Outreach and Development The team will begin outreach to possible program volunteers, and consult with educators to determine the workload feasibility. We will leverage our network to connect with more organisations, educators, graphic designers, etc. in order to grow the volunteer base. The workshop programming will be developed largely in this period through new volunteers and the existing curriculum design team.

December 21- January 8, 2023	Team Out-of-Office The team will pause operations for the holidays and resume on January 8th. E-learning lessons will continue at the tutors' and students' discretion.
January 9 - January 20, 2023	Budget Finalization Upon announcement of the GLOCAL grant results, the team will reevaluate the budget, considering fundraising opportunities and existing funding as well. This will inform the final venue rental, wages/number of hired professionals, etc. and the programming.
January 21 - March 13, 2023	Host Program
March 14-15, 2023	Collect Participant Feedback, Assess Need for Additional Supports

Conclusion:

In summary, our project, an extension of our existing Community E-Learning Initiative, titled "English Language Learning for Systems Navigation and Civic Engagement", will equip newcomer parents with both the English language skills and civic knowledge necessary to advocate for themselves and their children within local education systems, and to improve their local education systems through civic engagement. Our program's curriculum will mobilise knowledge around the following topics: 1) Types of school systems in Ontario; 2) Navigating different academic and applied learning streams for students; 3) Engaging your local school trustee; 4) Understanding the local civil service, and the role which municipal, provincial and federal governments have in your child's access to education. Our two-month intensive program, designed based on the extensive knowledge we have gained from operating our Community E-Learning Initiative, will not only improve the English language skills of newcomer parents, but also to increase their levels of civic engagement within their local communities.

For any further instructions please contact:

joseph.ong@glocalfoundation.ca

madina.mashkoori@glocalfoundation.ca

Thank you.

